Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥8

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ K Q 5
♦ A Q J
♣ K J 4 2

♠ 7 5 2
♥ 10 7
♦ 6 5 4
♣ A 9 8 7 6

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ 9 8 4 3 2
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 3

♠ Q 10 8
♥ A J 6
♦ K 10 9 3
♣ Q 10 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			

4NT by North
Lead: ♥8

NORTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

SOUTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam. Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites NORTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point NORTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ 9 8 7 5
♦ 10 9 6 4
♣ 9 6

♠ J 10 4
♥ A J 6
♦ K 5 3
♣ 10 8 7 2

♠ 9 6 5
♥ K Q 2
♦ A 8 7
♣ K Q J 3

♠ K Q 7 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ Q J 2
♣ A 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			

2NT by East
Lead: ♥4

EAST opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

WEST, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite EAST to bid game if he has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

EAST doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 2
♥ A K
♦ 7 6 4
♣ A K Q 5

♠ K
♥ Q 9 8
♦ Q 10 9 8 5 3
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 6 4 3
♥ J 10 7 5 3
♦ 2
♣ J 9 8

♠ J 9 7 5
♥ 6 4 2
♦ A K J
♣ 7 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠K

NORTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1♣.

SOUTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1♠.

NORTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3♠ and SOUTH bids the game.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 6 ♥ J 10 5 4 ♦ A 8 2 ♣ Q 10 6 4	
♠ K Q J ♥ K Q 8 ♦ Q J 9 3 ♣ A K 2	N W E S	♠ 5 4 3 ♥ A 7 2 ♦ K 10 6 5 ♣ 9 8 5
	♠ A 9 8 7 2 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ 7 4 ♣ J 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥4

WEST has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

EAST knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider slam so she just bids 3NT.